

according to Grand View Research. Khorakiwala says the patient pool for Zaynich in India runs into hundreds of thousands, a significant opportunity that sits alongside the far larger US prize. “India is a very important market from a business point of view as well,” he says. Europe, where the European Medicines Agency has granted Zaynich accelerated assessment status, adds a further \$400-500 million in potential peak sales.

THE LAUNCH PLAN

Wockhardt is targeting a US entry by end of 2026 or early 2027. It is going in independently, a strategic

tariffs on Indian pharmaceutical imports. “We are partnering with a company for capital-intensive areas, while keeping the intellectual work and leadership in-house,” says Khorakiwala. “The product should be available in the US around the first quarter of 2027.”

In India, Zaynich will be marketed directly through Wockhardt’s existing anti-infectives field force, with launch expected around December 2026 or January 2027. Pricing will reflect the public health imperative, at 15-20% of US levels, where a 7-10-day course costs between \$10,000 and \$15,000. “India will be priced at an 80% discount to

ing sustained external capital. EBITDA margins expanded to 18.7% in FY26 from 13.8% in FY25, driven by the exit from loss-making US generics, better supply chain efficiency and the shift towards higher-margin products.

WHAT COMES NEXT

Khorakiwala says Zaynich is the opening of a new chapter. Zaynich, WCK 6777, a once-daily injectable antibiotic that has already completed Phase 1 trials in the US, is being developed for the outpatient treatment market, a segment that could prove even larger than the hospital market Zaynich is targeting.

The management is targeting revenues of ₹6,000 crore by FY28, rising to ₹12,000 crore by FY31, as against ₹3,373 crore in FY26. Achieving these will depend on how quickly Zaynich gains traction in the US market.

“We are actively transforming ourselves into a more research-based company,” he says. “This is not a one-product story. A number of products are already in the pipeline globally, and our investment in antibiotic research will continue. We see clear white space globally.”

The first quarter of 2027, when Zaynich is expected to begin reaching American patients, will be the moment the financial community starts forming its view. Market access negotiations, formulary placements and the pace of hospital adoption across the United States will test whether Wockhardt’s commercial organisation is as capable as the scientific one that built the drug. The drug works. The FDA agrees. Whether the balance sheet follows is what the next three years will determine. **BT**

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THE UK BUSINESS IS THE LARGEST BY GEOGRAPHY, CONTRIBUTING 39% OF CONSOLIDATED REVENUES AND GROWING 13% YEAR-ON-YEAR

choice that reflects confidence in its commercial capabilities and a determination to retain the full value of what it has built rather than licensing it away.

The US team is led by Zahabiya Khorakiwala, who currently oversees the group’s hospital segment.

For capital-intensive operational functions, the company is working with external partners while keeping commercial strategy and leadership in-house. Supply for US will target European markets through third-party contract manufacturers, specifically in Italy, whose facilities were reviewed by the FDA as part of the approval process. Khorakiwala notes that manufacturing from Europe also shields Zaynich from potential US

that,” says Khorakiwala.

While Zaynich is commanding all the attention, it has not yet generated a single rupee of revenue. The business sustaining Wockhardt through this transition is its pharmaceuticals operation across India, the UK and Ireland.

The UK business is the largest by geography, contributing 39% of consolidated revenues and growing 13% year-on-year. Ireland’s Pinewood Healthcare contributes a further 11%.

Together with India formulations, biotechnology products and insulin, this base business contributes roughly 75% of consolidated revenues and generates the stable, predictable cash flows that have funded innovation without requir-